A static method is one that is called on a class, not on an object. Such methods cannot access properties. The name of a static method is the class name, followed by two colons and the function name. For instance, this calls the p( ) method in the HTML class:

HTML::p("Hello, world");

A class's documentation tells you which methods are static.

Assignment creates a copy of an object with identical properties. Changing the copy does not change the original:

```
$f = new Person('Fred', 35);
$b = $f;                          // make a copy
$b->set_name('Barney');           // change the copy
printf("%s and %s are best friends.\n", $b->get_name(),
$f->get_name( ));
```

Barney and Fred are best friends.



Class names are case-insensitive and must conform to the rules for PHP identifiers.

6.3 DECLARING A CLASS

To design your program or code library in an object-oriented fashion, you will need to define your own classes, using the class keyword. A class definition includes the class name and the properties and methods of the class. The class name stdClass is reserved. Here's the syntax for a class definition:

```
class classname [ extends baseclass ]
{
    [ var $property [ = value ]; ... ]

    [ function functionname (args) {
          // code
      }
      ...
    ]
}
```